

Aging and People with Disabilities**Number: APD-PT-26-001**

Authorized by: Jane-ellen Weidanz

Issue date: 2/5/2026

Subject: Local Office Lift Chair Approvals

Transmitting (check the box that best applies)

- ☐ New policy ☒ Policy change ☐ Policy clarification ☐ Executive letter
☐ Administrative Rule ☐ Manual update ☐ Other:

Applies to (check all that apply):

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ All ODHS employees | ☐ County DD Program Managers |
| ☒ Aging and People with Disabilities | ☐ Developmental Disabilities Services |
| ☒ Area Agencies on Aging: Type A and B | ☐ Self-Sufficiency Programs |
| ☐ Child Welfare Division | ☐ Support Service Brokerage Directors |
| ☐ Children's Intensive In Home Services | ☐ Stabilization and Crisis Unit |
| ☐ Children's Residential Services | ☐ Other (please specify): Enter Text |

Policy/rule title: Local Office Lift Chair Approvals

Policy/rule numbers: OAR 411-035-0030, OAR 411-016-0110

Release number:

Effective date: Upon release

Expiration date:

References:

Web address: <https://www.oregon.gov/odhs/providers-partners/seniors-disabilities/Pages/services.aspx>**Discussion/interpretation**

Note: [Updated information in brackets]

This transmittal introduces a new process that allows Local Office (LO) **Managers** and **District Managers** to approve lift chair purchases up to \$1,500 for individuals receiving Long-Term Services and Supports (LTSS) or Oregon Project Independence – Medicaid (OPI-M). Purchases

above this amount must continue to be submitted to Central Office (CO) for review and approval.

Previously, all lift chair requests required CO approval. This created delays in service delivery and added administrative steps for LOs. This change is being implemented to streamline decision-making, improve timeliness, and support individuals in accessing needed equipment.

Implementation/transition instructions

Managers are responsible for verifying the following before an approval is made:

- The individual is receiving LTSS or OPI-M. Individuals receiving State Plan Personal Care (SPPC) are not eligible.
- The individual is assessed at least minimum assist in transfer assistance as identified in the most recent CA/PS or OPI-M PLAN.
- Case Manager (CM) has recorded the request in Oregon ACCESS (OA) case narration, including alternatives discussed.
- Three bids are obtained; if fewer, the reason must be documented in OA narration.

Important:

- Delivery fees and disposal fees are allowable and are not included in the \$1500 approval limit. Delivery fees and disposal fees may not exceed \$300.00.
- Bids cannot include warranties or other add-ons.
- Recliners without a lift function cannot be approved since they are not an assistive device.
- When possible, the individual needs to test out the chair and ensure it will meet their needs prior to authorization and delivery.
- Selected lift chair must fit the individual's size and needs. As an example, the seat width and depth will fit the individual's body. When possible, choose a chair with a weight capacity at least 50 pounds above the individual's current weight.
- Special fabrics and other options that are above and beyond the minimum necessary to meet the needs of the individual are not permitted.
- For replacement lift chairs, the reason must be clearly documented in OA.

Approvals and Denials

All decisions must be documented in the individual's OA case. For approvals, a [Manager Lift Chair Approval Checklist](#) has been created and can be found in the K-plan Forms section of CM Tools. This checklist must be signed by the approving manager and a copy saved to the individual's file. Digital signatures/approvals are acceptable and must be attached to the checklist when saved to the individuals file if on a different document (for example, email).

Managers may deny lift chair requests and the CM will notify the individual of the denial using form APD 540, Notification of Planned Action. Managers can reach out to CO for assistance with denial language and the following denial language examples may be used and adjusted as needed:

- **Recliner chair:** The request for a recliner is denied. A recliner is considered furniture, not assistive technology. OAR 411-035-0010(5)(11), 411-035-0025, 411-035-0030(4)
- **Lift Chair:** You do not have an assessed need for a lift chair. A lift chair will not increase your independence, decrease the need for assistance from another person, or improve your health and safety. OAR 411-035-0010(5)(11), 411-035-0030(1)(a)-(c)

Payment

Lift chair purchases **cannot be made using a SPOTS card** and all payments must be made after the chair is delivered and accepted by the individual. Once this is complete, LOs must complete the following steps:

For LTSS cases:

Staff will enter the payment into the MRP ONE system after the invoice has been received. Guidance for entering MRPs in ONE can be found in the [Program Payments and Support QRG](#).

The ONE system currently limits payments to a maximum of a \$1000. If the purchase is over \$1000 it will require two payment entries.

- For example: One payment for \$1000 and second payment for \$500.

A manager or district manager will approve the MRP payment(s) in ONE after entry. LO sends the LO Lift Chair Checklist to KPlan.Requests@odhsoha.oregon.gov. This is required for expenditure tracking and audit purposes.

For OPI-M cases:

Lift chairs can only be paid through invoice. LO staff will need to send the checklist, invoice, and a W-9 from the provider to the CO OPI-M team at [KPlan.Requests@odhsoha.oregon.gov and include "OPI-M Invoice" in the subject line.]

Quality Assurance Monitoring

CO will audit local office lift chair approvals quarterly to ensure compliance with policy and rules. Findings will be shared with Managers and District Managers to help identify training and support needs.

Local/branch action required

Local offices should begin using the Lift Chair Checklist immediately and ensure all staff are aware of the new guidance. Managers should direct staff to CM Tools for full instructions and resources.

Central office action required

CO will monitor the implementation of this change, provide support as needed, and conduct LO audits. To support LO leadership, CO has scheduled the following webinar for leadership to discuss the best practice for reviewing and approving lift chair requests. Please contact CO at least two weeks before the webinar if accommodations are needed.

Webinar details and registration:

- When: February 5, 2026, 1-2pm

Registration: https://www.zoomgov.com/webinar/register/WN_xvgAisNVR0eIkbSCS_zuUg

Reviewed by impacted parties? ☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, reviewed by: Central Office, Training unit, Ops Review

Filing instructions:

If you have any questions, please contact:

Contact(s): J.D. Tilford – Medicaid Services and Supports Manager

Email: APD.MedicaidPolicy@odhsoha.oregon.gov